Betting on 3D?
3D broadcast was expected to hit the markets by the year 2000, then 2006. The current bets are on 2010.

Other manufacturers making 3D TVs

Philips, Panasonic, LG, Mitsubishi, Sharp, NEC, Hitachi and Sony are in the race for taking over the 3D TV market.

LG

LG is just the next brand in the growing line of consumer companies that are caving to be one of the elite few in the 3D run. LG has accepted that 3D TV is the next big thing and is also pushing forward their research to enter this market. Regrettably, that's about all the details that LG is willing to shed light on. We hope LG doesn't make us wear those horrid looking glasses though.

Hitachi

Hitachi has gone ahead and has done something which the others still haven't reached. What we are talking about is not only 3D TV, but also controlling such a TV with hand gestures. Hitachi was another brand that was showcasing its 3D TV technology advancement at CES 2009. This high-end TV panel of theirs, works with a Canesta 3D sensor that allows TV viewers to interact with the controls of the TV through hand gestures. This TV is not just a prototype, but will be available soon. Soon you will be able to change the channels, even if you can't find your remote control.

Sharp

Sharp has started off without waiting for television and movie producers to shift to equipment that produce 3D content. Instead, it is researching ways to convert 2D content such as videos into 3D. This would not only create new openings for content by converting old and current films and TV shows, but depending on the efficacy of the technology, could even eliminate the need for studios to invest in any new filming equipment at all. Sharp has used technology similar to Philips'. However, unlike Philips, it involves only a pair of images that will be recognised separately in each eye. However, in order for this to work, the viewer must be sitting still in one postition.

NEC

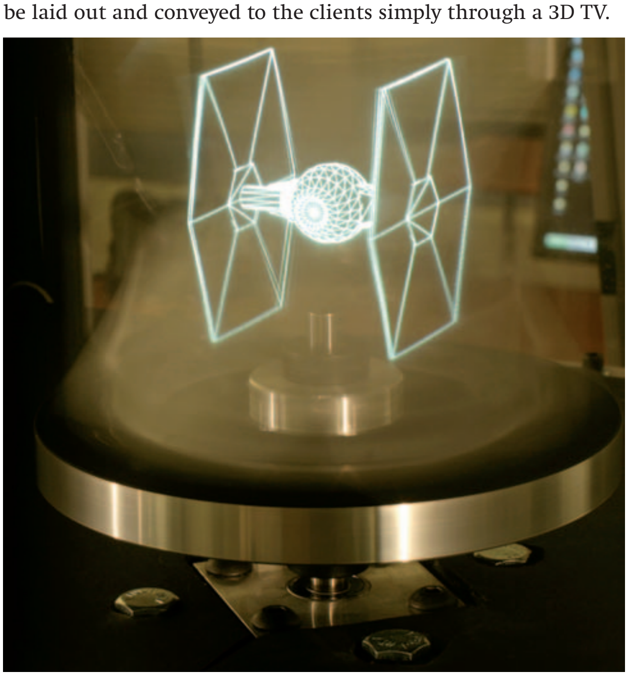
NEC has been working on a prototype to bring 3D TV to your mobile phone. We really don't know what NEC wants to accomplish by doing so, as the screen size is said to be only 3.1 inch as 3D images never jump out beyond the frame of the screen you are looking at. This means you need to be holding the device really close to your face to have the full effect of 3D on your mobile phone. NEC wants to show how its hardware can decode and display 3D images in real time on a compact device.

Mitsubishi

Mitsubishi has its own concepts and theories on 3D TV and doesn't want to be left behind. It has managed to demonstrate a scalable system for real-time acquisition, transmission and stereoscopic display of dynamic scenes, which actually means 3D TV. However, we think it still really needs a lot of work done as the video that is available for preview doesn't match up to the others.

People get easily distracted by shiny objects being displayed on a regular television and if it is a product, it will be wanted by all. This is a common advertising strategy that is used by companies to lure people into purchasing their products without actually getting to see them first hand. Traditional television is limiting the viewers from actually finding out the full features of a product. Utilising 3D TVs as a mode to sell products will give potential buyers a better look at the product and will not be dissapointed with what they purchase. Those tele scammers will finally be dealt with.

When 3D TVs go mainstream, which won't be very long, even professionals like Architects and Interior Designers will benefit from it. Creating and presenting their projects can be done with much more ease. Plans for building and homes can be laid out and conveyed to the clients simply through a 3D TV.



Images will actually be transformed into reality

Using your LCD or plasma TV, that is wall mounted, to display beutiful pictures of art work is now a common thing seen in households that have these TVs. Now think about those images actually popping out of that screen, letting people view it in a whole new way. Luxury at home will soon know a new meaning with 3D Art. Sculptors and artisans normally create intricate designs before actually executing them, but sometimes things don't turn out as originally planned as what they view is on a 2D plane. But with 3D playing a roll here as well, things will always go as planned.

3D technology has inspired many other similar fields. There are researches that are working towards creating a chip in cameras that can actually capture an image and convert it into a three-dimensional one with actual depth and distance. As this technology is new it does have it's own kinks that need to be sorted out. But this has also helped to reduce noise and other distortion in images. This 3D technology would make a welcome addition to the cameras of the future. As battery capacities expand and processors become more powerful, cameras will be able to sport these chips with ease. Although the price would probably be higher than a traditional sensor, being able to take 3D photos would certainly be worth it, at least for some.

3D is just the start of things and is already looking very promising. The next thing that this will evolve into is holographic imaging. The day will come when communicating between people will feel that you are actually talking to the person right next to you. Even your watch or mobile phones (if they will still exist) will be able to transmit this type of video and with a voice interface you can actually see the person you are speaking with right next to you even though he or she might be in another part of the world. Holograms are also useful is so most of the mentioned 3D TV applications. For example, in the field of education, many students opt for higher education through distance learning programs, which works out to be tough due to physical isolation, but will soon be able to sit in a holographic classroom along with the other students.

What the future holds for us all is still not certain, but what is certain is that we are moving in the right direction and have definitely had a good start. How long it will take to reach the destination is upto all of us, whether to appreciate and accept the technology put forth is all our choice. We have already made our choice and can't wait to see this technology turn into a complete reality, what about you? ■

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